What is this survey about?

This survey is about your views on the inflation rate in Germany. We want to find out how German economists think about inflation: where does it come from, how long will it stay, what factors will they influence in the future.

We are very interested in your thoughts and assessments. There are no wrong answers. The survey is anonymous. All information is voluntary. However, we would ask you to always answer honestly. Even if you feel that another answer is "desired" - please listen to your feeling.

Thank you for participating!

This survey contains 13 questions.

Important

On the next page you will find an open question. We would like to ask you to record your thoughts and views - in your own words - there.

In our experience, it takes about two minutes to answer the question. This answer is particularly valuable for our research. So please take a little time and answer conscientiously and honestly.

Why has the inflation rate in Germany increased?

In the years 2000-2020, the inflation rate in Germany was never higher than 3%. With a few exceptions, it was consistently very close to the ECB's target (2%).

However, the inflation rate has been rising for over a year. One year ago it was 3.1%, well above the average of the last 20 years.Currently, it is 10.4% (as of November 2022).

What do you think: What has led to this rise in inflation?
(Please answer in full sentences)

Please enter your answer here:

Your forecast for the future

Remember that the inflation rate has never been higher than 3% in the last 20 years. However, it is currently 10.4%.
What do you think: is this level permanent or temporary?

Please select only one of the following answers:

- ◯ Temporary: In 5 years at the latest, inflation will be below 3%
- ◯ Permanent: In 5 years the inflation rate will still be above 3%

In some of the following questions, we will ask you how likely you think certain developments are.
Specifically, we will ask you for percentages**.Your partial answers can take any value from 0 to 100.**

The only important thing is that the probabilities you give to scenarios must add up to 100% per question.

For example, as follows:

- With a 70% chance, I think the sun will shine permanently tomorrow
- With 20% probability the sun will be covered by clouds from time to time
- With 10% probability it will be permanently covered

We are interested in how likely you think the inflation trend is.

In your opinion, what is the percentage probability that the following scenarios will become reality in the next 12 months?

Please enter your answer(s) here:

The inflation rate will be 12% or higher amount	
The inflation rate will be between 8% and 12%	
The inflation rate will be between 4% and 8%	
The inflation rate will be between 2% and 4% are	
The inflation rate will be between 0% and 2%	
The deflationary rate (the opposite of inflation) will be between 0% and 2% amount	
The deflationary rate (the opposite of inflation) will be between 2% and 4% amount	
The deflationary rate (the opposite of inflation) will be between 4% and 8% amount	
The deflationary rate (the opposite of inflation) will be between 8% and 12% amount	
The deflationary rate (the opposite of inflation) will be 12% or higher	

Now refer to the next *4-5 years (48-60 months in the future).*

In your opinion, what is the percentage probability for the following scenarios?

Please enter your answer(s) here:

The inflation rate will be 12% or higher amount	
The inflation rate will be between 8% and 12%	
The inflation rate will be between 4% and 8%	
The inflation rate will be between 2% and 4% are	
The inflation rate will be between 0% and 2%	
The deflationary rate (the opposite of inflation) will be between 0% and 2% amount	
The deflationary rate (the opposite of inflation) will be between 2% and 4% amount	
The deflationary rate (the opposite of inflation) will be between 4% and 8% amount	
The deflationary rate (the opposite of inflation) will be between 8% and 12% amount	
The deflationary rate (the opposite of inflation) will be 12% or higher	

Why has the inflation rate in Germany increased?

There are many possible explanations for why inflation is currently at 10.4%. Below we show you 10 reasons that are often mentioned in the public discussion as influencing factors.
We are interested in the importance *given* to possible influencing factors .
We would therefore ask you to weigh the factors below so that the individual values add up to 100. If you think all factors have the same influence, give each factor a value of 10.

How do you estimate the impact of the following factors on the current inflation rate?

Please enter your answer(s) here:

High production costs of the companies due to many vacant positions (for example, because many in Corona Lost or active in their job have changed)	
High production costs of the companies due to disturbances in the Supply chains	
High demand for goods and Services based on Government expenditure and Rescue programmes (short-time allowance, Discount on fuel, VAT reduction, etc.)	
Increased electricity and heating costs due to the global energy crisis	
The European Central Bank has too much Money put into circulation	
High demand for goods and Services based on the Reopening the economy after Corona (money that households have previously saved, is now output)	
Central bank interest rates too low	
High inflation expectations for the Future that will lead to Consumers prefer purchases, Employees Higher wage claims and companies their prices increase	
Strong price increases of Companies to increase profits	
Other reasons	

What other factors do you think contributed to the current inflation rate?

Please enter your answer here:

Now we are interested in your assessment of how much the above factors will play a role in the future.

Which of the following factors do you expect will influence inflation over the next 12 months?

Please select the correct answer for each item:

	Will play a role	Won't matter
High production costs of the companies due to many unfilled jobs (for example, because many have lost their job in times of corona or have actively changed)		
High production costs of companies due to supply chain disruptions	◯	◯
High demand for goods and services due to government spending and rescue programs (short-time allowance, discount on fuel, VAT reduction, etc.)	◯	◯
Increased electricity and heating costs due to the global energy crisis	◯	◯
The European Central Bank has put too much money into circulation	◯	◯
High demand for goods and services due to the re-opening of the economy after Corona (money that households have previously saved is now being spent)	◯	◯
Central bank interest rates too low	◯	◯
High inflation expectations for the future, which lead to consumers preferring purchases, employees demanding higher wages and companies raising their prices as a precaution	◯	◯
Strong price increases by companies to increase profits	◯	◯
Other reasons	◯	◯
	◯	◯

What other aspects do you think will influence the inflation rate in future?

Please enter your answer here:

There is a lot of news about inflation in the media these days. The number of articles dealing with inflation is at its highest in 20 years. We are interested in whether and how the reporting changes the citizens' view on inflation.

How do you estimate the impact of inflation reporting on the following variables?

Please select the correct answer for each item:

	0 - There is no influence	1	2	3	4	5 - There is a strong influence
Acute inflation perception of households	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
Inflation expectations of households for the near future	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

Stay up to date

If you would like to be kept informed of the results of the investigation, please click on Yes. In order to *be able to reach you in this case, please write an empty e-mail with the subject "Research results" to tobias3.schmidt@tu-dortmund.de. Thank you for your support!*

Please select only one of the following answers:

◯ Yes, I would like to be kept up to date with the results of research

Optional feedback

If you like, please give us feedback on our survey. Thank you!

Please enter your answer here:

Thank you for participating!

For questions or comments on the survey, please write to the person who created the survey:

13.12.2022 – 16:16

Send your completed questionnaire:
Thank you for answering the questionnaire.